And other interpretations, like Bohm's, added hidden variables to quantum physics, a move that DeWitt thought was unnecessary. "What if we assert that the [Schrödinger equation] is all, that nothing else is needed?" he wrote in *Physics Today.* "Can we get away with it?The answer is that we can."

DeWitt used the rest of the article to advocate Hugh Everett's "relative-state" interpretation of quantum physics, which DeWitt had subscribed to since his correspondence with Everett in 1957. Everett had never talked explicitly about many worlds, but DeWitt ventured where Everett hadn't bothered to tread, rechristening the idea as the "many-worlds" interpretation. "The universe is constantly splitting into a stupendous number of branches, all resulting from the measurementlike interactions between its myriads of components," DeWitt wrote. "Moreover, every quantum transition taking place on every star, in every galaxy, in every remote corner of the universe is splitting our local world on earth into myriads of copies of itself." DeWitt knew that this idea was dazzlingly strange:

> I still recall vividly the shock I experienced on first encountering this multiworld concept. The idea of 10^{100+} slightly imperfect copies of oneself all constantly splitting into further copies, which ultimately become unrecognizable, is not easy to reconcile with common sense. Here is schizophrenia with a vengeance.

Nonetheless, DeWitt argued, many-worlds "has a better claim than most to be the natural end product of the interpretation program begun by Heisenberg in 1925." He pointed out that the interpretation does not require wave functions to ever collapse and claimed that it didn't require anything else at all.

Many readers of *Physics Today* were unconvinced by DeWitt's arguments. "The idea of infinitely many multiplying, noninteracting worlds should be taken somewhat less seriously than the Ptolemaic [earth-centered system's] epicycles," wrote one physicist in reply. "At least Ptolemy's theory 'explained,' in some sense, the one observable world without invoking infinitely-many unobservable worlds." The many-worlds interpretation "would also imply the (happy!) feeling that if an airline passenger were in an aircraft about to crash, he need not really worry, for in another world, this same aircraft… will land at home, safe and sound,"